

Russell Dudek

INTERVIEW THESIS BRIEF | SERVERFARM DATA CENTER CAMPUS DIRECTOR

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania | 412.287.8640 | russelldudek@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/russelldudek | https://russelldudek.github.io/serverfarm/

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Parallel growth with reliability.

A candidate hypothesis for managing the pressure between hyperscale expansion and the operating disciplines that protect people, plant, customers and capital.

Actual mandate: make a growing Southwest campus portfolio safer, more reliable, more financially legible and more customer-trusted while integrating new capacity, vendors, technology and operating standards into 24/7 execution.

Company moment

\$3.0B in North American development financing; 500MW+ Houston potential; CTX2 moving into MEP and commissioning; high-density, water-conscious infrastructure; a role-level 4x growth ambition.

Central contradiction

Speed-to-market creates value only when the live campus can absorb change without borrowing reliability from tomorrow.

White-space thesis

Use a Campus Paralleling Review to make authority, plant condition, procedure, partner readiness and customer continuity explicit before work proceeds.

Strongest objection

No claimed direct colocation tenure or unverified Tier/CFM/CEM/PE credentials. The argument is adjacent high-consequence operating evidence plus respect for experienced technical authority.

Operating tensions

Tension	What it protects	What happens if unresolved
Speed vs control	Market timing and disciplined execution	Handoffs become risk transfers.
Visibility vs judgment	InCommand insight and expert authority	More alerts without better decisions.
Local vs standard	Campus reality and portfolio learning	Either bureaucracy or repeated failure.
Density vs sustainability	AI performance and resource efficiency	Design promises separate from operating behavior.

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OPERATING SYSTEM

The Campus Paralleling Review

A one-line decision model: the live campus and growth/change path connect only when five interlocks carry evidence and ownership.

1. Authority

Life-safety, technical, operational and customer decision rights; escalation and stop-work boundaries.

2. Plant condition

Current redundancy, alarm, maintenance and dependency state sufficient for the proposed action.

3. Procedure

Approved method, contingency, stop conditions, evidence requirements and closure definition.

4. Partner readiness

Internal and vendor owners, parts, schedule, competence and accountability are confirmed.

5. Customer continuity

Impact, communication, SLA implications, escalation and trust consequences remain visible.

Learning closure

Results, recurrence, new standard work and portfolio-level reuse are captured after execution.

Decision states

State	Meaning	Leadership action
Proceed with controls	Required interlocks are closed with explicit owners and evidence.	Execute, monitor and close learning.
Bound and replan	Work is viable, but one or more dependencies need constraint.	Reduce scope, change window or strengthen contingency.
Escalate	Risk or customer consequence exceeds local decision boundary.	Bring the right authority and options, not merely the problem.
Hold / stop	Plant state, procedure, authority or evidence is insufficient.	Protect the live campus and remove pressure to normalize uncertainty.

AI's bounded role: help synthesize history, recurring alarms, work-order text, vendor patterns and evidence gaps. Human technical and life-safety authority retains the decision.

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PROOF, MEASURES AND DISCOVERY

What I would test in the interview.

Evidence map

- **Amazon:** 24/7 site launch, cadence, escalation, Lean/Gemba and customer-backward scale.
- **Compunetics:** high-reliability engineering, manufacturing, quality systems, root cause and controls.
- **Vape-Jet:** current cross-functional signal integration, telemetry and standard work.
- **ZeusVu:** regulated authority, chain of custody and 100% safety record.

Balanced measures

- people and life safety
- plant availability and recurrence
- customer communication and closure
- OPEX/CAPEX and vendor performance
- commissioning/handover readiness
- PUE/WUE and operating efficiency

Executive questions

#	Question	Why it matters
1	Where is growth creating the greatest operational handoff burden?	Locates the mandate behind the title.
2	Which decisions need more consistency, and which must remain local?	Tests standardization boundaries.
3	How do InCommand, site expertise and executive escalation meet?	Connects data visibility with authority.
4	What distinguishes a strong campus director after 12 months?	Clarifies success measures and culture.
5	Where do customer commitments collide with maintenance or expansion?	Exposes the trust/risk interface.
6	What learning is hardest to transfer across campuses?	Finds the portfolio reuse opportunity.

Interview stance: tactical empathy before prescription. The review model is a hypothesis to improve, reject or replace after seeing the actual operating system.